Send Statements: User Guide

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What this tool does

Send Statements replaces PDF-eXPLODE for the weekly statement run. You pick the weekly statement PDF, check the list it builds, and click Send. Nothing is emailed or printed until you confirm.

Each week FoxPro saves one large PDF with every statement in it. Send Statements:

- Splits that PDF into individual statements.
- Combines all statements for the same email address into one PDF, so each person gets one email.
- Lists every statement so you can review it before anything goes out.
- Emails, prints, or skips each one, based on what you choose.
- Saves a copy of everything it sent, sorted by week and by person.

Statements that have no email address are listed as **No Sender** and are set to print.

Before you start

Check these four things before each run:

- **You can open the Statements folder on the shared drive.** The app will not start without it.
- **Outlook is installed and signed in to your work mailbox.** It must be the regular (classic) Outlook. Outlook does not need to be open; the app opens it in the background.
- **Your default printer is set** in Windows, if anything will be printed. Printing goes straight there with no print window.
- **Only one person runs it at a time.** If someone else has it open, you will see a message saying who, and the app will not open until they close it.

Opening the app

Double-click the **Send Statements** icon on your desktop. It can take a few seconds to open.

Across the top of the window you will see:

Button or label	What it does
1. Choose file	Pick this week's statement PDF
2. Send	Emails and prints everything in the list. Shows how many of each, for example "Send (104 email, 21 print)"
Edit selected	Change the email details for one row
Settings	Set the sender, subject, message, file name and send delay for everyone
From: … Delay: …	The sender and delay that will be used. Shown in red if no sender is set

The big list in the middle is empty until you choose a file. The bar at the bottom shows progress and a short summary.

To close the app, click the X in the corner. It cannot be closed while it is sending.

First-time setup: the Settings button

Set these once before your first run. **You cannot send any emails until a sender is chosen.** Settings are shared, so a change one person makes applies to both users.

1. Click **Settings**.
2. Fill in each field:

Field	What to enter
From	The mailbox the emails come from. Pick it from the list of accounts in your Outlook. It starts as "(choose a sender)" on purpose, so nothing goes out from the wrong mailbox.

Field	What to enter
File name	The name of the PDF the customer receives, for example `statement.pdf`
Subject	The email subject, for example `Statements {date}`
Body	The message text of the email
Send delay	How many minutes emails wait in your Outbox before they go out, from 0 to 1440. Use 0 to send right away.

3. Click **Save**.

Type `{date}` anywhere in the subject, body or file name and it is replaced with today's date when the emails are sent. In the subject and body it looks like 11/10/2026. In the file name it looks like 11-10-2026, because file names cannot contain slashes.

A send delay of 10 to 30 minutes is a good safety net. It gives you time to stop an email after you click Send (see Stopping an email after Send).

After saving, the sender and delay show next to the Settings button, for example **From: ar@company.com Delay: 30 min**.

The weekly run, step by step

A normal week takes five steps: choose the file, review, adjust, send, and read the summary.

1. **Open the app** from the desktop icon.
2. **Click 1. Choose file.** A file window opens in the Statements folder with the newest PDF already selected. If it is the right week, click **Open**. If the file is somewhere else, such as your Desktop, browse to it the same way you would open any file.
3. **Wait for the list to load.** The bar at the bottom shows progress. When it finishes, it shows a summary such as "171 statements, 216 pages. 104 email recipients, 21 No Sender."
4. **Review the list.** Rows that need a look are at the top in red or yellow. See Reading the list for what each color and note means.

5. **Spot-check a few statements.** Double-click any row to open that person's PDF and make sure it looks right.
6. **Make any changes.** Click the **Action** column to switch a row between Email, Print and Skip. Use **Edit selected** to change one person's email address, subject, message or file name.
7. **Check the sender** next to the Settings button. If it says "none set" in red, click Settings and choose one.
8. **Click 2. Send.** A confirmation box shows how many will be emailed, printed and skipped, the sender, the printer, and when the emails will leave.
9. **Click Yes** to go ahead, or **No** to go back and make more changes.
10. **Wait for it to finish.** Do not close the app while the progress bar is moving.
11. **Read the summary.** It shows how many were emailed, printed and skipped, any errors, when the emails will leave, and the folder where everything was saved.

After the summary, the list clears and the app is ready for the next file.

Reading the list

Each row is one email or one printout. Rows that need a look are sorted to the top.

Columns

Column	What it shows
Action	What will happen to this row: Email, Print or Skip. Click it to change.
Recipient	The email address it goes to, or **No Sender** if the statement has no email
Statement for	The name on the statement. If one email covers several statements, it shows the first name and " (+5 more)"
Pages	Total pages in that person's PDF
File name	The attachment name for emailed rows
Check this	Notes on anything worth a look

Row colors

Color	Meaning
Red	Cannot be emailed as it is. Usually a No Sender statement, set to Print.
Yellow	Worth a quick look before sending
White	Nothing unusual
Grey text	Set to Skip. Nothing will happen to it.

Row types

Row	Default action	Notes
An email address	Email	Every statement for that address is combined into one PDF
No Sender	Print	A statement with no email address. One row per statement. You can type an email address in Edit to email it instead.
Untagged pages	Skip	Pages that are not part of any statement, such as the report totals page at the end. Normally leave it on Skip.

Notes in the Check this column

Note	What it means	What to do
No email. Print or skip.	The statement has no email address	Leave it on Print, or add an address with Edit
New recipient	This address has never been emailed by the app before	Open the statement and confirm the address looks right
Pages up from X last time	This person has far more pages than last time	Open it and make sure two customers were not combined

Note	What it means	What to do
To address looks wrong	The address is not a valid email	Fix it with Edit, or Print or Skip
Too large to email	The PDF is over the 20 MB email limit	Print it or skip it
Could not build PDF	Something went wrong making that statement	Skip it and tell IT
Edited	Someone changed this row's details with Edit	Check the change is what you meant

On the very first run, every address shows as New recipient. That is expected, because the app has no history yet.

Changing what happens to a statement

You can change any row before you click Send. Changes only apply to this run.

Switch between Email, Print and Skip

Click the word in the **Action** column. Each click moves to the next choice: Email, then Print, then Skip. Only choices that make sense are offered; a row with no email address only switches between Print and Skip.

Open a statement

Double-click a row (anywhere except the Action column) to open that person's PDF. Close it when you are done; it does not change anything.

Edit one person's email

1. Click the row once to select it.
2. Click **Edit selected**.
3. Change any of these:
    - **Action**: Email, Print or Skip
    - **To**: the email address. Type one here to email a No Sender statement.
    - **From**: the sender for this one email

- **File name**, **Subject**, **Body**: for this one email

4. Click **Save**.

The row's note will show **Edited**. Everything you did not change keeps the Settings defaults.

The Edit window also has:

- **Open statement**: opens the PDF so you can check it while editing.
- **Reset to defaults**: undoes all edits on this row.
- **Cancel**: closes without saving.

Sending and printing

Clicking **2. Send** always shows a confirmation first. Nothing happens until you click **Yes**.

The confirmation shows:

- **Email:** how many, and the sender they come from
- **Print:** how many, and the printer they go to
- **Skip:** how many will be left alone
- When the emails will go out, based on the send delay

After you click Yes, a progress bar counts through each email and printout. Emails go to your Outbox and wait for the send delay. Printouts go straight to your default printer.

When it finishes, a summary shows how many were emailed, printed and skipped, any errors with the first few names, the time the emails will leave the Outbox, and the folder where everything was saved.

When Send is blocked

The app stops before anything is sent if something is not right:

Message	Why	What to do
email(s) have no From address	No sender is chosen	Choose one in Settings, then click Send again
From accounts aren't set up in this Outlook	The chosen sender is not in your Outlook	Pick a sender from the list in Settings

Message	Why	What to do
No default printer could be found	Windows has no default printer	Set a default printer in Windows
File changed	The PDF was changed or moved after you opened it	Click Choose file and open it again
Count mismatch	The pages or statements do not add up	Do not send. Contact IT.

If some rows fail

If one email or printout fails, the rest still go. The summary lists the failures, and their PDFs are saved in the **Not Sent** folder for that run so you can handle them by hand.

Stopping an email after Send

You can stop an email only while it is still waiting in your Outbox, before the send delay runs out. The summary tells you the time they will leave.

1. Open Outlook and go to the **Outbox**.
2. Find the email by recipient. The subject is the one from Settings, for example "Statements 11/10/2026".
3. Delete it.

To stop all of them, click one email in the Outbox, press **Ctrl+A** to select all, then press **Delete**.

Once an email has left the Outbox, it cannot be recalled from outside customers. If the send delay is 0, emails leave right away and there is no time to stop them.

Where files are saved

Every run saves its statements in two places inside the **Output** folder on the shared drive: one folder per week, and one folder per person.

```
Output\
  Runs\
    2026-11-10 wk 21, yr 26\
      Emailed\        one PDF per email address
      Printed\        one PDF per printed statement
      Not Sent\       skipped rows and anything that failed
      send_log.csv    a list of every row and what happened to it
  Recipients\
    joe@example.com\
      2026-11-03 statement.pdf
      2026-11-10 statement.pdf
```

- **Runs** has one folder for each run, named with the date and the weekly file name. Use it to see everything from a given week.
- **Recipients** has one folder per email address, holding a dated copy of every statement emailed to that person. Use it to find an older statement for a customer.
- **send_log.csv** opens in Excel. It lists each row with its action, recipient, sender, subject, pages and result.

The weekly PDF itself stays where FoxPro saved it.

If you open a weekly file that was already sent, the app warns you with the date and who sent it, and asks whether to open it anyway. This helps prevent sending the same week twice.

Messages you might see

Most messages tell you exactly what to fix. If one is not listed here or does not go away, contact IT and include a screenshot.

Message	What it means	What to do
Can't reach the statements folder	The shared drive is not available	Check you are on the network or VPN and can open the Statements folder, then try again
Statements are already being sent by [name]	The other user has the app open	Wait until they close it. If nobody has it open, contact IT.

Message	What it means	What to do
Outlook could not be opened	Outlook is not installed, not signed in, or is the new Outlook	Open classic Outlook once to make sure it signs in, then reopen the app
[file] was already sent on [date] by [name]	This week's file has been sent before	Click No unless you are sure it needs to go again
email(s) have no From address	No sender is chosen	Click Settings and choose a sender
From accounts aren't set up in this Outlook	The sender is not one of your Outlook accounts	Choose a different sender in Settings
No default printer could be found	Windows has no default printer	Set a default printer in Windows Settings
File changed	The PDF changed after you opened it	Click Choose file and open it again
Count mismatch	The pages or statements in the file do not add up	Do not send. Contact IT.
Can't read file	The PDF is damaged or still being saved	Wait a minute and try again. If it still fails, contact IT.
Send delay must be a whole number from 0 to 1440	The delay in Settings is not a number	Enter a number of minutes, such as 15
Errors in the summary	Some emails or printouts failed	Find those PDFs in the run's Not Sent folder and send or print them by hand

Weekly checklist

1. Open **Send Statements** from the desktop.
2. Check **From** and **Delay** next to Settings. Fix in Settings if needed.
3. Click **1. Choose file** and open this week's PDF.
4. Look at every red and yellow row at the top.
5. Double-click a few rows to spot-check the statements.
6. Change any Action or details you need.

7. Click **2. Send**, read the confirmation, and click **Yes**.
8. Read the summary. Handle anything listed as an error.
9. Collect the printouts from the printer.
10. Close the app so the other user can use it.

For IT: configuring and building the app

This section is for whoever maintains the tool. End users only need the .exe and a desktop shortcut.

Files

File	Purpose
`send_statements.py`	The app source. Folder paths and technical settings live at the top.
`build.bat`	Installs the build tools and builds `Send Statements.exe`
`README.md`	Technical reference for every flag and setting

Keep these three somewhere safe. You need them to change anything and rebuild.

Requirements on the build PC

- Windows with Python 3 installed from python.org. Use `py` in commands; `python` and `pip` may not be on the PATH.
- Internet access for pip during the first build.

Users' PCs need no Python. They need classic Outlook signed in to their mailbox, a default printer, and access to the share.

1. Set the folder paths

Open `send_statements.py` and edit the Settings section at the top. These paths are built into the .exe.

Setting	Set to
`STATEMENTS_FOLDER`	Where FoxPro saves the weekly PDF. Must already exist. The lock file lives here.
`OUTPUT_FOLDER`	Where the Runs and Recipients folders are created
`LOG_FOLDER`	Where settings, history and logs are kept

Output and Logs are created automatically. Both users need **Modify** rights on the statements folder and on the locations of Output and Logs.

Other settings at the top rarely need changing: `MAX_ATTACHMENT_MB` (20), `PRINT_DPI` (300), `DELAY_MINUTES` (10, the starting delay until one is saved in the app), and the tag patterns that match the FoxPro PDF. The README describes each one.

2. Build the .exe

1. Put `build.bat` in the same folder as `send_statements.py`.
2. Double-click `build.bat`. It installs pymupdf, pywin32, pillow and pyinstaller, then builds the app.
3. When it says Done, the app is at `dist\Send Statements.exe`.

Only the .exe is needed. The `build` folder and `Send Statements.spec` are leftovers and can be deleted.

If the build fails on a newer Python, install Python 3.13 and change both `py -m` lines in `build.bat` to `py -3.13 -m`.

3. Sign and deploy

1. Sign the .exe with the internal code-signing certificate, or allowlist it in Defender and AppLocker. Unsigned builds are often flagged.
2. Copy it to the share, for example `\\fileserver\share\Statements\App\Send Statements.exe`.
3. Give each user a desktop shortcut to it.

4. Test before handing off

Make a separate test shortcut. Add flags to the end of its **Target** field after the closing quote:

```
"Send Statements.exe" --mode dryrun --folder C:\StatementTest --output
C:\StatementTest\Output --logs C:\StatementTest\Logs
```

Mode	Emails	Printing	Records history
`send` (no flag)	Sent	Printed	Yes
`--mode display`	Opened in Outlook, not sent	Printed	No
`--mode dryrun`	Not touched	Not printed	No

Test modes show the mode in the window title, such as **[DRYRUN MODE]**, and save to a run folder ending in "(dryrun test)". Point `--folder`, `--output` and `--logs` at a local test folder so tests never touch the real share. The users' shortcut must have no flags.

Running the .exe with no flags sends for real, from whatever sender is chosen in Settings.

5. Reset before go-live

After testing against the real Logs folder, delete these so users start clean:

- `settings.json`: so the sender starts as "(choose a sender)"
- `sent_files.json`: so no week shows as already sent
- `recipient_history.json`: so the history starts fresh

Changing it later

Edit `send_statements.py`, run `build.bat` again, test with a dryrun shortcut, then replace the .exe on the share. Users' shortcuts keep working. Email defaults (sender, subject, body, file name, delay) are changed in the app's Settings, not in the script.